

The coming bear market need not catch you off guard, and indeed can be used to your great advantage, as discussed in Chapter 21. Once you have prepared for the downside, you can spend your time and energy focusing on how you will take advantage of the upturn due thereafter, which is not, after all, that far away in the future. When contemplating the implications of wave structures of the size discussed in this chapter, it is well to keep in mind these words from *Elliott Wave Principle*:

If the existence of the planet Earth is conceived to have lasted so far one year, life forms have been with us for about five weeks, while manlike creatures have walked the Earth for only the last six hours of the year, less than $1/100$ of the total period during which life forms have existed. To put these time periods in perspective, we should note that on this basis, Rome dominated the Western world for a total of five seconds. Viewed from this perspective, a Millennium wave isn't really of such large degree after all.